Day 11 (stop 1 of 2) - Ray Lowes

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 16 · Borer's Falls / Rock Chapel

2.1 km / 1.3 mi	~0.6 h	1.0 km new	49 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

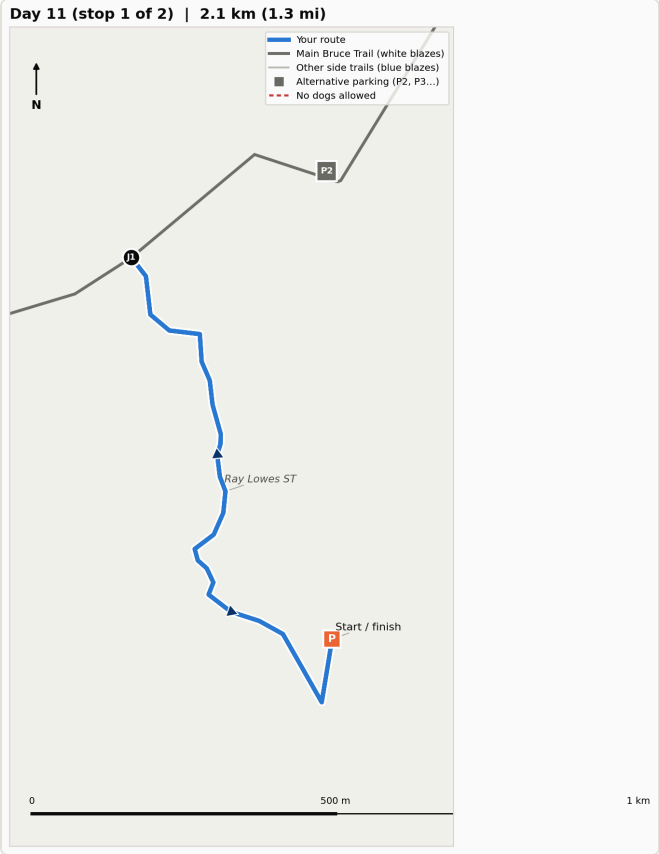
Park (P): Parking at Borer's Dog Park on York Rd just south of Valley Rd (Hopkins Corners) provides access to the York Road Side Trail. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day11a_hike016.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Ray Lowes Side Trail (1.0 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 11 (7.0 mi of hiking, about 123 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 17, 5.7 mi from Roadside parking on Kingsview Dr off Paramount Dr. Provides access to Kingsview….

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** The Borer's Dog Park lot on York Rd just south of Valley Rd, described by a trip report as free. Tourism Hamilton suggests arriving early or on weekdays and not parking on the roadside if lots are full.
- **Ray Lowes Side Trail:** Named for Ray Lowes, who first proposed a continuous escarpment trail in 1959. Expect hard-packed dirt with occasional roots and rocks, and some climbing; one writer calls the walk from the dog park toward the falls "an uphill battle." This is a short out-and-back.
- **Along the way:** A trip report on this side trail mentions the railway bridge over York Rd (trains are frequent), a cut-stone culvert just west of York Rd, and the 1860 Rasberry farmhouse with a leaning stone silo.
- **Borer's Falls nearby:** The 15 m curtain falls (also called Rock Chapel Falls) is about 30-40 minutes' walk from the dog park, beyond this route. Flow is seasonal and best after rain or in early spring.
- **Cautions:** Do not cross the active CN rail tracks. Stay on marked trails (the area has rare plants), keep back from slopes and edges, and keep Zappy close. Watch for poison ivy in summer and slippery footing in winter.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking on Valley Rd map	Free	1.0	550 m	

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Parking at Borer's Dog Park on York Rd just south of Valley Rd (Hopkins Corners) provides…. Head south on the blue-blazed Ray Lowes Side Trail.
1.0	0.6	J1: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.1	1.3	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Tourism Hamilton, Hiking the GTA and I've Been Bit.